

14 > Unlock Virtual Desktops

- how to create, rename, reorder, and close desktops
- how to move apps between desktops (and pin key apps everywhere)
- how to set different wallpapers so your brain always knows where it is
- the keyboard shortcuts and touchpad gestures that turn this into muscle memory
- three ready-to-copy workflows (Student, Office, Developer)
No extra software. No registry hacks. Just Windows 11 doing Windows 11 properly.

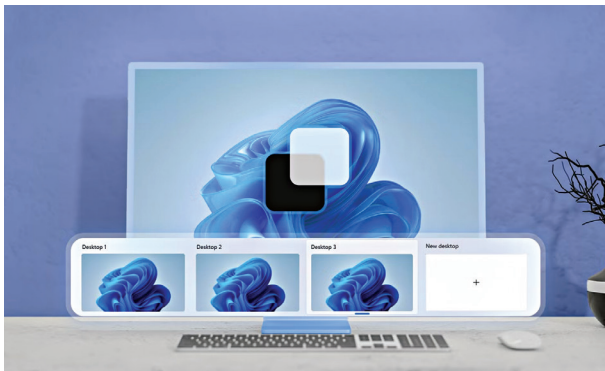
1) “Separate spaces”, not “more screens”

Virtual desktops are not extra monitors. They’re separate layers of the same screen. You can keep your “Work” apps open on Desktop 1, switch to Desktop 2 for “Personal”, and your work mess stays parked where it belongs.

Think of it like having multiple desks in the same room:

- You can walk between them instantly.
- Each desk can have its own stuff open.
- You stop mixing everything into one chaotic pile.

And here’s the key: virtual desktops don’t make you faster by themselves – they make you faster because they remove friction. Less searching, less alt-tabbing roulette, fewer wrong-window moments during meetings.



2) Task View is Mission Control

Everything about virtual desktops lives inside Task View.

Step-by-step: Open Task View

- Press Windows key + Tab to open Task View.
Or:
- Click the Task View button on the taskbar (if enabled).

In Task View, Windows shows:

- all open windows
- all desktops (usually at the bottom)
- controls to create new desktops
- the ability to drag windows between desktops

Fast Track habit: If you forget where a window went, don’t hunt. Press Win + Tab. Task View is your “map”.

3) Create, rename, reorder, close

Step-by-step: Create a new desktop

Method A (Task View)

1. Open Task View (Win + Tab).
2. Click New desktop.

Method B (Keyboard shortcut)

- Press Win + Ctrl + D to create a new desktop instantly.

Step-by-step: Rename desktops (so they’re not “Desktop 3” forever)

1. Open Task View (Win + Tab).
2. Click the desktop name (or right-click the desktop thumbnail)
3. Rename it to something human: Study, Work, Meetings, Coding.

Step-by-step: Reorder desktops (match your workflow)

1. Open Task View
2. Drag desktops left/right into your preferred order
Put your most-used desktops next to each other so switching is a simple rhythm.

Step-by-step: Close a desktop

- Press Win + Ctrl + F4 to close the current desktop.
Or:

1. Open Task View
2. Hover over a desktop thumbnail
3. Click the X to close it

Important: Closing a desktop doesn’t “kill” your apps. Windows shifts those open windows to another desktop (usually the one next to it). That’s why desktops are safe to experiment with.

4) Switch desktops fast

Keyboard switching (the power-user way)

- **Win + Ctrl + Right Arrow:** switch to the desktop on the right
- **Win + Ctrl + Left Arrow:** switch to the desktop on the left

These two shortcuts are the difference between “I use virtual desktops” and “I tried them once.”

Touchpad switching (laptop users, this is for you)

On a precision touchpad:

- Swipe four fingers left/right to switch desktops.

Microsoft also notes you can change what three- and four-finger gestures do from Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Touchpad, under the gesture sections.